



Glossary

Here are the meanings of some words that are useful for you to know when learning all about oceans.

absorb To take in something

adapt When an animal or plant becomes better-suited to its habitat. For example, a penguin's thick feathers keep it warm in icy places

algae Simple, plantlike organism that is found in or near water. Seaweed is a type of algae

bacteria Tiny living things

basalt rock Type of rock found on the ocean floor

bathyscape Type of submersible

bioluminescence Chemical reaction in which an animal produces light

blubber Thick layer of fat in some animals, such as whales; it protects them from the cold

breed To produce offspring

camouflage Patterns or colors on an animal's skin that help it blend in with the environment

cargo Goods carried on board a ship

chasm Deep crack in the ground

climate Weather patterns for a specific area

climate change Process of the Earth's climate changing over time

colony Group of animals who live together, such as seabirds

conservation Protecting an area of the Earth, such as the oceans

coral reef Huge rocky structure, which has grown gradually from the skeletons of tiny marine animals

decibel Unit that measures the loudness of sound, where silence is 0 decibels (dB)

dorsal fin Fin located on the back of a marine animal, such as a shark

ecosystem Living community of plants and animals found together, and their environment

environment Surroundings in which an animal lives

erosion Breaking down of rock by wind and water

evaporation When water heats up and turns into water vapor

flooding When a river or the ocean overflows and fills land with water

fossil fuel Type of energy that is not renewable, such as oil

fresh water Water that is not salty, such as in rivers, ponds, and most lakes

glacier Large mass of ice that moves slowly down a slope

global warming When worldwide temperatures rise